

Nathalie El-Bazzal

PhD Candidate in Economics • University of Paris 8 • Research Affiliate at the Paris School of Economics

nathalie.elbazzal@psemail.eu • [Website](#) • [LinkedIn](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Trade • Geoeconomics • Political Economy • Global Value Chains

EDUCATION

University of Paris 8, France

2026-Present

PhD Candidate in Economics

Thesis: Trade Shocks and Geoeconomic Fragmentation

Supervisor: **Prof. Jamel Saadaoui**

University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, France

2024-2026

Pre-Doctoral Studies in Economics

With Highest Honors (GPA: 4.0/4.0)

Relevant coursework: Econometrics; International Trade; Applied Quantitative Methods; Firm Competitiveness; Trade and Finance

ESCP Business School, France

2020-2021

MSc in Financial Management

Thesis: Foreign Direct Investment in a Conflict Country: The Syrian Case

Sciences Po Grenoble, France

2018-2020

Master's Degree in International Relations - Middle Eastern and Mediterranean Studies

Thesis: Economic Recovery in Syria under Political Instability

University of Lille, France

2014-2018

Bachelor's Degree in Political Science

Third year at Saint Joseph University of Beirut, Lebanon (2017-2018)

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Working Paper

Trading Under Fire: Houthi Attacks and the Disruption of Global Shipping

Single-authored

Work in Progress

Geopolitics, Geoeconomics, and Politics: A Survey and Event-Classification Protocol

With **Jamel Saadaoui** (University of Paris 8)

Geoeconomic Fragmentation and Market Integration during the Syrian Conflict

With **Pierre-Louis Vézina** (King's College London)

Measuring Bilateral Geopolitical Tensions

With **Jean-Charles Bricongne** (Banque de France), **Benoît Chaulvet** (University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne), **Thomas Renault** (University Paris-Saclay), and **Jamel Saadaoui** (University of Paris 8)

Research Notes

When Market Spillovers Are Not Geopolitics

2026

With **Jamel Saadaoui** (University of Paris 8)

How Sanctions Redraw Oil Trade Flows, 2022-2025

2026

With **Homayoun Falakshahi** (Kpler)

RESEARCH GRANTS & AWARDS

Best PhD Student Paper Award

2026

Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC) · Forum for Research in Empirical International Trade (FREIT)

Awarded for Trading Under Fire: Houthi Attacks and the Disruption of Global Shipping.

CEPR ReCIPE Big Research Grant

2026-2028

£100,000

Trade and Financial Frictions in Fragmented Economies

Co-Principal Investigator with **Pierre-Louis Vézina** (King's College London) and **Jean-Charles Bricongne** (Banque de France).

I initiated, conceptualized, and led the proposal for this highly competitive grant.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Paris School of Economics, France

2026-Present

Junior Researcher

- Conduct research on international trade, geoeconomics, and geopolitical fragmentation.
- Lead the scientific coordination and day-to-day management of the CEPR ReCIPE research project.

IRIS Sup' - Institute for International and Strategic Affairs, France

2023-Present

Master's Thesis Supervisor and Project Leader

- Supervise Master's theses in geopolitics, international trade, and development.
- Supervise professional group reports on public-private partnerships, economic diversification, labor markets, and geopolitical disruptions.

University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, France

2025-2026

Teaching Assistant in Economics

- Introduction to Econometrics, third-year Bachelor's level, Spring 2026.
- History of Economic Thought, third-year Bachelor's level, Fall 2025.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026: 5th Kiel-CEPR Conference on Geoeconomics (Junior Poster Session) (Berlin, Germany. November); Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT) (Alghero, Italy. September); European Trade Study Group Annual Conference (Exeter, United Kingdom. September); Inaugural Conference of the Economic Data Science Society (EDSS) (Poster) (Banque de France, Paris, France. July); World Trade Dialogue (Hamburg, Germany. April).

DISCUSSANT ROLES

2026:

Discussant for **Evading Sanctions**, by **Feodora A. Teti** (LMU Munich & ifo Institute), **Lisa Scheckenhofer** (ifo Institute), **David Torun** (University of Zurich), and **Joschka Wanner** (University of Würzburg), at the **Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (FREIT)**.

Discussant for **Geopolitical Risk and Foreign Dependence in Global Shipping**, by **Simon Fuchs** (Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta), **Fernando Leibovici** (Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis), and **Woan Foong Wong** (University of Oregon), at the **World Trade Dialogue**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business France - French Embassy, Cairo, Egypt

2022-2024

Trade Advisor - Industry and Cleantech

- Conducted sectoral economic analyses across energy, infrastructure, transport, water, waste management, and security.
- Advised more than 160 firms on market-entry strategies and international expansion across MENA.
- Organized high-level trade missions across Egypt, Jordan, Tunisia, and the UAE.

Safran, Paris, France

Nov. 2021-Jan. 2022

Digital Transformation Analyst

- Conducted quantitative analysis of digital-transformation strategies and organizational performance.
- Synthesized academic literature to support strategic decision-making.

ESCP Business School, Paris, France

Sept. 2021-Feb. 2022

Research Assistant and Project Coordinator

- Coordinated research projects within the Corporate Governance and Retailing Chairs.
- Contributed to applied research on foreign-direct-investment screening and retail transformation.

French High School Charles de Gaulle, Damascus, Syria

2019-2020

Chief Education Advisor

- Managed academic operations and implemented strategic educational policies in a complex geopolitical environment.

Business France - French Embassy, Doha, Qatar

Sept. 2018-Mar. 2019

Trade Officer

- Conducted economic and sectoral analyses of Qatari industries.
- Organized the Qatar-France Business and Investment Forum.
- Supported economic exchanges between French and Qatari partners.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Sport

Former High-Level Athlete - Wrestling

Silver medal, French National Championships (2015); bronze medal (2014); medalist in international competitions.

Other Activities

Delegate - ESCP Alumni MENA

March 2023-Present

Founder - Public Speaking Club

2016-2020. Conducted workshops in France, Lebanon, and Qatar.

Journalism Intern - Aujourd'hui la Turquie

July-August 2018 · Istanbul, Turkey

SKILLS

Coding and Software: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX

Languages: French and Arabic (native); English (fluent)